

GRIOT & GRITS

Hi. My name is Ty McDuffie, and I am excited to introduce you to Griot and Grits, a unique project aimed at preserving and celebrating Black history in a modern, engaging way. Inspired by the West African griot—the storyteller, poet, and historian who passed down the history of the village—Griot and Grits is committed to preserving the stories that have shaped our community, adding the power of advanced technology to create an immersive historical experience like no other.

What is Griot and Grits?

Griot and Grits allows for the recording, storing, and sharing the powerful stories that make up the fabric of our lives, ensuring they are accessible to future generations. Just think of it as a library of Black family oral and video histories told by the ones that lived it, in their own, unique voices.

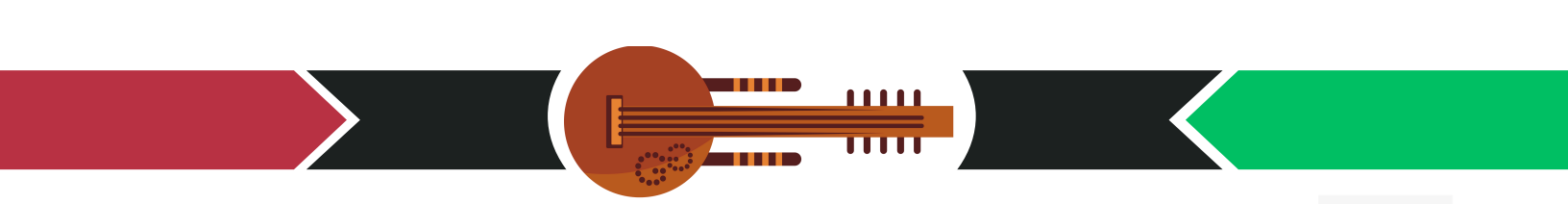
How Does It Work?

1. **Recording Stories:** Our first step is to capture the stories that matter—stories of triumph and loss, love and resilience, and experiences of youth and elders alike. These stories will reflect the diversity and depth of the Black experience, straight from the voices of our own families and community members.
2. **Enriching Each Story with AI:** Once recorded, we'll enhance these stories using AI to add relevant context, photos, sounds, and historical background. This brings key moments to life in a documentary-like format, allowing us to create "books" with family "chapters" that make it easy for individuals to explore and understand their own heritage.
3. **Creating the Griot and Grits Library:** Finally, all stories will be housed in our digital library—a comprehensive, searchable archive dedicated to Black life and legacy. This library will serve as a vital community resource, preserving our shared history for generations to come.

Because churches, fraternities, sororities, civic groups, Black-owned businesses and more are at the heart of the communities we aim to celebrate, we would be honored to partner with your organization. We're planning on-site recording sessions and would love the opportunity to host days at your location to gather stories from your members and your surrounding community.

By becoming part of our network of "Griot Villages," your organization can help ensure that these stories are preserved forever; a lasting testament to the strength, wisdom, and enduring spirit of the African American community.





G R I O T & G R I T S

How do you become a “Griot Village”?

What is a Griot Village?

Griot Villages are simply organizations within the community that have agreed to partner with Griot and Grits by opening their doors to host onsite recordings of Black American family histories.

Why should you become a Griot Village?

There are several reasons why your organization should partner with Griot and Grits as a Griot Village. Among them are:

1. **Preserve your community’s family histories.** Organizations like yours have always been a cornerstone of the Black American community. Churches have become community spiritual and healing centers. Fraternities and sororities have grown to become the vanguard in quests for educational opportunities, political voice, and social equality. And Black-owned businesses have cemented themselves as the lifeblood of our neighborhoods.
2. **Facilitate Spiritual Reflection:** Family histories often include stories of faith and perseverance, providing opportunities for spiritual reflection and inspiration for others.
3. **Community Service:** Providing space for recording family histories is a meaningful way to serve the community, offering resources and support for a project that might otherwise be inaccessible to some families.
4. **Building Trust and Collaboration:** Partnering with Griot and Grits can strengthen relationships with your organization’s members and the local community by demonstrating an unwavering commitment to the preservation of Black family history.

If you’re interested in becoming a Griot Village, please reach out to me directly at **at (919) 332-7969** or via email at **info@griotandgrits.org**.

Thank you for considering this journey with us.

Warm regards,
Ty McDuffie



Learn More About Griot and Grits



The Story behind Griot and Grits

Learn about the idea behind Griot and Grits and the path forward for Griot and Grits



Griot and Grits - Our Recipe

See how we record, enhance and preserve Black family oral and video histories for future generations.



Concept Video with Griot and Grits AI Enhancements

